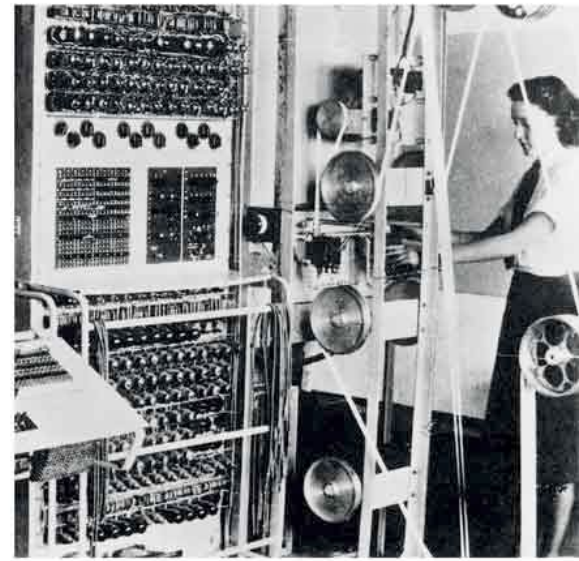


Secret computers

The world's **first working computers** were both kept top secret. The first programmable computer was the Z3, invented by Konrad Zuse during World War II, and was used to make **SECRET CODES** for Germany. Britain, Germany's enemy in the war, built Colossus (right), the first digital electronic computer. Colossus enabled Britain and its allies to **break the German codes**, giving them access to top-secret German information.



Apple Macintosh

The early computers were the size of **several elephants**. Transistors and then microprocessors gradually made computers smaller and cheaper, but early computer users needed skill and specialized technical knowledge. In 1976, Americans Steve Wozniak and Steve Jobs began to change that with their **APPLE** computers, designed so that anyone could use them. Other companies soon followed, making computers cheaper, smaller, and easier to use. Soon, they were in schools, offices, and homes **across the world**, in technology as diverse as cell phones, cars, and even toilets.



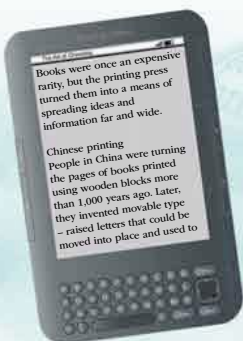
Did you know?
Babbage's Difference Engine No. 2 was first built in 1991, 142 years after it was designed—and it worked!

The iMac featured a computer and monitor display in one colorful case.

How it changed

Computers have revolutionized almost every part of modern life in some way—our workplaces, schools, and even our social lives, since they are in the things we use every day.

the world



E-BOOK READERS have been around since 1998, but started to become popular in the 2000s, and **TABLET COMPUTERS** followed not long after.



SOCIAL NETWORKING sites have sprung up thanks to computers and the Internet. The most famous is **FACEBOOK**, started in 2004 by American Mark Zuckerberg.